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W E D N E S D A Y , J A N U A R Y 1 , 2 0 2 5

Healey gives lawmakers 11% raises in new year

Top Democrats will now make \$224,000

By Matt Stout
GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey on Tuesday ordered an 11 percent increase in the base salaries of Massachusetts lawmakers, pushing the total annual pay for the Legislature's top Democrats to \$224,000 a year beginning Wednesday.

Healey detailed the change in a letter she sent Treasurer Deborah Goldberg and released to the Globe on Tuesday.

For many lawmakers, this will be the second raise they've notched in roughly a week. State officials last week announced that Healey and other statewide constitutional officers would get a separate 10 percent pay bump come Jan. 1, a change that, under state law, also triggers increases to the various leadership and travel stipends legislators collect in addition to their base salary.

The changes are part of a complicated biennial process, under which two separate adjustments — one guaranteed by the state constitution, the other baked into a 2017 law — tie the pay of the state's most powerful leaders to changes in the state's wage levels. But the separate adjustments are often based on different sets of data, meaning they regularly differ.

The change required by the constitution is determined by the governor, who every two years must decide whether the annual base salary for legislators, which was \$73,655 in 2024, should be adjusted based on changes to the

RAISES, Page B4

Mission Hill opposition keeps housing plan in limbo

By Esmy Jimenez
GLOBE STAFF

Two decades after developers first pitched an idea to build housing in the space that once housed the long-vacant St. Alphonsus Hall, a historic community complex that included a theater and hosted performances in Mission Hill, plans to move forward with the more than 200-unit project have stalled — again.

In tabling the project from Weston Associates at the most recent Boston Planning and Development Agency meeting in November, board members pointed to the swell of neighbors and community groups who have balked at the proposal, citing affordability concerns and lack of outreach from developers, among other complaints.

“We’ve probably reviewed 200 to 300 projects,” said BPDA board member Kate Bennett during the meeting. “I’ve never seen such universal opposition coming from many corners.”

The resistance seemingly goes beyond the typical not-in-my-backyard sentiment that has stymied developments in the past. Several neighbors who spoke with the Globe, those who filed letters against the project, and city leaders say trust has eroded among residents who see

MISSION HILL, Page A10



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

The Mission Hill site once housed the long-vacant St. Alphonsus Hall, which was eventually demolished in 2023.

On energy bill, more than met eye

An effort to ban third-party suppliers died despite widespread support. A key House figure's romantic involvement with a lobbyist raises issues.

By Samantha J. Gross
and Sabrina Shankman

GLOBE STAFF

As spring turned to summer and the Massachusetts Legislature geared up for its end-of-session sprint, a bill to crack down on “competitive energy suppliers” seemed finally poised to pass. Iterations had come and gone in

past sessions, but the bill, which would ban third-party electricity suppliers from signing up new residential customers, finally had the backing of some of the state's top elected officials: the governor, the attorney general, and the mayor of Boston, to name a few. The effort had momentum.

But when a sweeping climate bill emerged after weeks of closed-door

negotiations this past fall, language to ban third-party energy suppliers, which buy electricity from the wholesale market and then sell it to consumers at a different rate, was nowhere to be found.

Nearly every branch of Massachusetts government supported taking on the industry, which had drawn scrutiny for what critics deemed predatory behavior toward mostly

older adults and those in low-income and minority communities.

Advocates and lawmakers were confounded.

What few knew at the time, was that a key lawmaker involved in the climate bill negotiations — Democratic Representative Jeff Roy, the House chairperson of the Legislature's joint energy committee — was engaged in a romantic relationship with one of Beacon Hill's most high-powered lobbyists, Jennifer Crawford.

ENERGY SUPPLIERS, Page A10

A FIRST IN LINE



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

The weather cooperated and the crowds turned out Tuesday for the First Night Boston celebration. Kara Casey of the Boston Puppeteers Cooperative marched in the parade, one of many activities at First Night, which began in 1976. **B1.**

A fond farewell to those who'll be long remembered

By Joseph P. Kahn
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

What deeds define a person's legacy? What qualities of character measure a life's worth? These questions seemed especially relevant at the close of a year when America's political leadership was embroiled in a fierce debate about the country's future — if not the fate of democracy itself — while barbarous wars overseas tested the mettle of world leaders.

Yet, sometimes strengths of character are not seeded in the glare of a political campaign or in gilded seats of power. Sometimes they are forged in a desolate, dirty jail cell. For Russian activist Alexei Navalny, questions of character were met with unflinching resolve. No attempts to silence him, even by poisoning or beatings, could stop him from publicly challenging the corrupt regime of President Vladimir Putin of Russia. For that, Navalny paid the highest price, dying last February in a prison north of the Arctic Circle at age 47, his stature as a human rights champion forever secured.

Jimmy Carter had both the glare of presidential campaigns and a seat of power, but his legacy was mostly soldered together in working-class neighborhoods of Middle America, where he built homes for the needy, and in the villages of Africa, where children are named after him for his work boosting farmers' yields a hundredfold and ridding regions of ancient scourges of disease. He also knew well the desolate jail cell, having in his “retirement” strong-armed several dictators into releasing thousands of political prisoners.

In good times and bad, dispiriting or uplifting ones, creative forces in fields like music and film express our highest aspirations and deepest hunger for artistic nourish-

DEATHS, Page A6



Jimmy Carter
Former president



Alexei Navalny
Russian opposition leader



Willie Mays
Baseball player



Alice Munro
Author

Faculties flex muscles with no-confidence votes at colleges

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

At colleges across New England, no-confidence votes are piling up.

Three times in as many years, professors at Lesley University came together to cast ballots over whether their president was fit to continue in her post. Then, just since May, similar moves to grab university presidents' attention — or remove them entirely — occurred at Emerson and Brandeis. And this month, nearly 80 percent of Suffolk faculty voted to censure its leaders, a measure of strong disapproval that stops short of calling for removal.

Since 2014, faculty at universities around New England have issued roughly 20 votes of no confidence or censure, more than double the decade prior, according to media reports.

They've happened everywhere from the Danvers campus of North Shore Community College to the furthest stretches of Maine's sprawling statewide university system, drawing inspiration from a nationwide uptick in no-confidence actions that include Columbia University, Cal Poly Humboldt, and beyond.

“These votes are transparent calls of concern by the faculty that something is happening with the institution that they are not happy with,” said Framroze “Fram” Virjee, president of the Association of Governing Boards of Universities

NO CONFIDENCE, Page A7

Point32Health reached a deal with Tenet Healthcare that will enable 17,000 customers to continue to receive care at four hospitals. **B5.**

A blackout hit nearly all of Puerto Rico, leaving more than 1.3 million people in the dark. **A2.**

Hiawatha Bray looks back at the year in tech and five stories that mattered. **B5.**

A white 15-year-old has pleaded guilty to attempted murder for trying to drown a Black teenager in a Chatham pond in 2023. **B1.**

The Red Sox talk a good game, but it doesn't help with free agents, writes Dan Shaughnessy. **C1.**

Got new resolutions? Try these dining spots that will help you keep them, not break them. **G1.**

Dropping the ball

Wednesday: Rain early, mild. High 48-53. Low 34-39.

Thursday: Sun returns. High 40-45. Low 27-32,
Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.



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